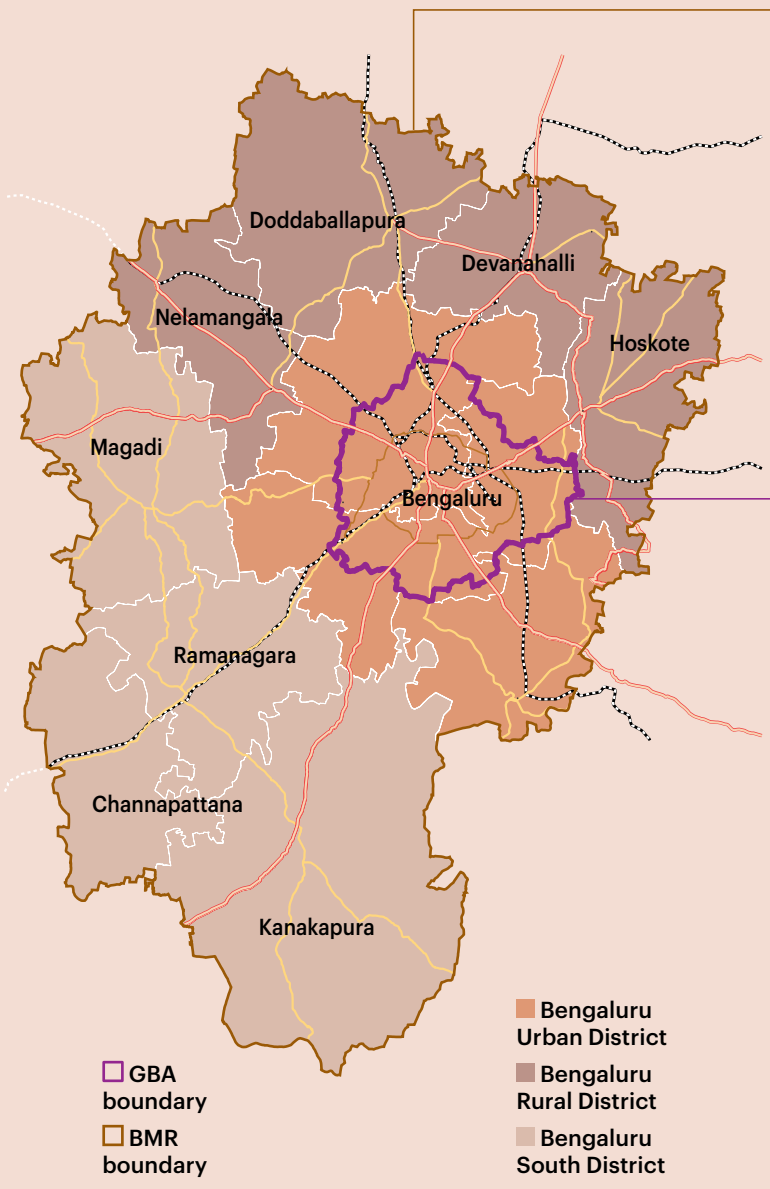
FIVE KEY GROWTH DRIVERS

- AI, Global Capability Centres (GCC), IT and tech startups
- Deep-tech manufacturing across seven priority sectors
- Tertiary healthcare, higher education, high-end tourism
- Planned urbanisation, enhanced liveability
- Public transport share to be upped from **35% to 75%** with Metro, suburban rail and Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS); a second airport; strengthened ring, radial and chord roads

BIG-TICKET INFRA SPEND

- Current plans envisage about **Rs 1 lakh crore** in infrastructure investment in Bengaluru by 2028
- By 2037, investment in the city is expected to triple to **Rs 3 lakh crore**



Bengaluru Metropolitan Region (BMR)

- **8,000 sq. km**, spread across three districts: Bengaluru South, Bengaluru Rural, Bengaluru Urban
- Population: **16 million +**
- Accounts for **40% of GSDP** of Karnataka

Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA)

- Area: **712 sq. km** of the Bengaluru city proper, at the heart of BMR
- Population: **14 million**
- Formerly Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike (BBMP) and incorporates its five city corporations
- Minister in charge: **Krishna Byre Gowda**

THE LONG VIEW

A six-time MLA and three-term minister, Byre Gowda, the US-returned son of late Janata politician C. Byre Gowda, is no stranger to Bengaluru's woes. After the 2008 delimitation redrew his erstwhile rural assembly constituency of Vemagal, he has represented Byatarayanapura—one of the city's airport-proximate northern neighbourhoods that has seen exponential growth of late. "The fact is, no city is growing as fast as Bengaluru," he says. At a recent India Today TV roundtable, he offered the stats. Bengaluru absorbs 36 per cent of the office space in all of India. Every denizen has a vehicle. Roughly rounded off, its vehicle-to-population ratio of 1:1 is thrice that of Mumbai, which has one vehicle for every three persons (1:3), and twice that of Delhi's 1:2. And the skew in total road length means Bengaluru groans under an ungodly 80,000-90,000 vehicles per sq. km—against 60,000-70,000 for Mumbai and Delhi's 50,000-60,000. Hence, the outward-looking Master Plan—a draft of which was recently reviewed by the CM—also entails heavy investment in city infrastructure. "Before 2028, we expect to pump in Rs 1 lakh crore into Bengaluru," says Byre Gowda. The plan is to double that by 2032, and treble by the 'Viksit Bengaluru' target year of 2037.

> **"The minister actually understands the problem and identifies the bottlenecks. He is capable and goes into detail. He's also politically very savvy"**
>
> **R.K. MISRA,** *Member, Bengaluru Political Action Committee, a citizens' group; Independent Director, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Ltd*

